Ford Motor Company

October 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD** Safety Recall 00S21: Certain 2000 Model Year Cars and Light Trucks - Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

REF: Dealer Announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV)

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year:

- Escort and Escort ZX2 vehicles built from May 3, 2000 through June 30, 2000 at the Hermosillo assembly plant
- Town Car vehicles built from April 11, 2000 through June 30, 2000 at the Wixom assembly plant
- Explorer vehicles built from April 12, 2000 through June 30, 2000 at the St. Louis assembly plant
- Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles built from May 3, 2000 through June 30, 2000 at the Louisville assembly plant
- Villager vehicles built from May 02, 2000 through June 30, 2000 at the Ohio Truck assembly plant
- Contour and Mystique vehicles built from May 3, 2000 through August 10, 2000 at the Cuautitlan assembly plant
- F-Series vehicles built from:
    - April 6, 2000 through April 25, 2000 at Ontario Assembly Plant
    - April 21, 2000 through May 5, 2000 at Norfolk Assembly Plant
    - April 17, 2000 through July 17, 2000 at Kansas City assembly plant
- Ranger vehicles built from:
    - April 26, 2000 through June 6, 2000 at Twin Cities Assembly Plant
    - May 3, 2000 through June 21, 2000 at Edison Assembly Plant
- Windstar vehicles built from April 27, 2000 through May 17, 2000 at Oakville Assembly Plant – for Europe only

NON-COMPLIANCE

Certain affected vehicles may have seat belt buckle assemblies that may not conform to Standard 209, paragraph S4.4 (b)(3) of the Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards which requires that the seat belt buckle assemblies withstand a force of not less than 13,345 N (3,000 lbs). Buckle assemblies in certain seating positions of the affected vehicles may not conform to this standard. In the event of an accident, this may increase the risk of personal injury for the occupant in the affected seats.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must inspect the date code on the seat belt buckles in certain seating positions on all affected vehicles and replace all seat belt buckle assemblies that fall within the suspect date code range.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Town Car owners affected by this recall. Please see dealer announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV). The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Town Car owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Town Car customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I:	Administrative Information
Attachment II:	Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III:	Technical Information
Attachment IV:	Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Customer Letter	

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S21
Certain 2000 Model Year Cars and Light Trucks –
Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: Town Car owners should receive the " Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure". Before calling Town Car owners, review Attachment IV to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of Attachment IV.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S21
Certain 2000 Model Year Cars and Light Trucks –
Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

If a part needs to be ordered, Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at owner's expense. Enter the word "LOANER" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area.

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Certain 2000 Model Year Cars and Light Trucks –
Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Inspect date code on seat belt buckle assemblies and return vehicle to owner.		
- Escort, ZX2 , Town Car, Villager, Ranger - Explorer/Mountaineer and - F-Series with 60/40 Seats	00S21A	0.2 Hrs
- Contour/Mystique, F-Series with Full Bench Seats, and Windstar (Europe Only)	00S21K	0.4 Hrs
Inspect date code, replace **ONE** seat belt buckle assembly:		
- Escort, ZX2, F-Series and Ranger with 60/40 seats, Town Car and Villager…….	00S21B	0.3 Hrs
- Windstar (Europe Only), Ranger with Bucket Seats, and Villager……..	00S21C	0.4 Hrs
- F-Series with Full Bench Seats, Contour and Mystique	00S21D	0.5 Hrs
- Explorer and Mountaineer ……..	00S21E	0.9 Hrs
Inspect date code, replace **TWO** seat belt buckle assemblies:		
- Windstar (Europe Only), Villager, and F-Series with Full Bench Seats …….	00S21F	0.5 Hrs
- Explorer and Mountaineer ……..	00S21G	1.4 Hrs
Inspect date code, replace **THREE** seat belt buckle assemblies:		
- Villager …….	00S21H	0.6 Hrs

Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling:*	Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"	See Attachment IV

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S21
Certain 2000 Model Year Cars and Light Trucks –
Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels. Not all vehicles will require new parts. Please perform the inspection before ordering parts.

Parts Application Chart: Seat Belt Buckle Assembly

Vehicle	Color	Seat Location	Service No
Contour and Mystique	Medium Prairie Tan	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) - R.H.	98BZ- 5461202-AAA
	Truffle (Greystone)	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) - R.H.	98BZ- 5461202-AAB
	Alchemy (Midnight Blue)	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) - R.H.	98BZ- 5461202-AAC
Escort	Medium Graphite	Belt Asy. (rear seat) - L.H.	XS4Z-54613B85-AAC
Escort ZX2	Midnight Black	Rear Seat L..H.	XS4Z-63613B85-AAB
Explorer And Mountaineer	Medium Prairie Tan	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) - R.H.	XL2Z- 7861202-AAB
	Medium Graphite	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) - R.H.	XL2Z- 7861202-AAC
	Dark Graphite	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) – L.H.	XL2Z- 7861203-AAA
	Medium Prairie Tan	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) – L.H.	XL2Z- 7861203-AAB
	Medium Graphite	Seat Belt Buckle End (front seat) – L.H.	XL2Z- 7861203-AAC
F-Series	Medium Parchment	Front Seat Center R.H.	YL3Z-15612B18-AAA
	Medium Graphite	Front Seat Center R.H.	YL3Z-15612B18-AAC
	Dark Graphite	Front Seat Center R.H.	YL3Z-15612B18-AAD
	Medium Graphite	Front Seat Center L.H.	YL3Z-78612B19-AAC
Ranger	Medium Prairie Tan	Front Seat R.H.	F87Z- 1061202-AAA
	Medium Graphite	Front Seat R.H.	F87Z- 1061202-AAD
	Dark Graphite	Front Seat R.H.	XL5Z- 1061202-AAA

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S21
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Seat Belt Buckle Assembly Inspection

Parts Application Chart: Seat Belt Buckle Assembly

Town Car	Midnight Black	Rear Seat R.H.	F8VZ- 5460044-AAE
	Medium Parchment / Light Parchment	Rear Seat R.H.	YW1Z- 5460044-AAA
	Medium & Light Graphite	Rear Seat R.H.	YW1Z- 5460044-AAB
	Medium Parchment	Rear Seat Center	YW1Z-54600A38-AAF
	Midnight Black	Rear Seat Center	YW1Z-54600A38-AAH
	Medium and Light Parchment	Rear Seat Center	YW1Z-54600A38-AAJ
	Medium & Light Graphite	Rear Seat Center	YW1Z-54600A38-AAK
Villager	Medium Portland	2nd Or 3rd Row R.H.)	XF5Z- 1260044-CCC
	Light Mink	2nd Row (Bench)	XF5Z- 1260044-DDD
	Light Mink	2nd Or 3rd Row L.H.	XF5Z- 1260045-AAA
	Medium Portland	2nd Or 3rd Row L.H.	XF5Z- 1260045-CCC
	Light Mink	Front Seat R.H.	XF5Z-1261202-AAA
	Medium Portland	Front Seat R.H.	XF5Z-1261202-CCC
Windstar (Europe Only)	Black	R.H. Front Buckle	XF2Z- 1661202-BBC
	Black	L.H. Front Buckle	XF2Z- 1661203-BBC

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DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Program Announcement Letter
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 17, 1998

To: All Lincoln Mercury and Ford Dealers

cc: Parts Managers
Service Managers

Subject: Announcing Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure for Certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

As part of our ongoing commitment to Lincoln customers, we are pleased to announce the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure to provide additional dealer compensation for certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs(ONP's) that affect Lincoln brand vehicles.

This additional compensation is being provided to allow dealers to provide personalized service designed to make the recall repair a positive experience for the Lincoln customer, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Each Recall/ONP Bulletin affecting Lincoln vehicles will indicate whether the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure is authorized; please note that not every Recall/ONP will qualify for this procedure and that the procedure will not be communicated to customers as a normal benefit of the Lincoln Commitment Program. Special handling and claiming instructions are included on the attached page. This program will apply only to Lincoln vehicles which have been delivered to customers.

We ask you to make maximum usage of these special enhancements to the Lincoln Commitment Program when applicable. Thank you in advance for your support of this program and our commitment to surprise and delight our Lincoln customers.

/O.S.B./
Mark Hutchins
President
Lincoln Mercury

/O.S.B./
M. D. Jordan
Executive Director
Ford Customer Service Division
North America

If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $58/hour and fuel cost of $1.05/gallon): 1.2 hrs. labor* = $69.60 9.0 gals fuel = 9.45 Wash/vacuum = 3.50 Total Submitted = $82.55 *travel time+fueling/washing labor
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer	Actual cost up to a maximum of $38 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	Up to 0.5 hour additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

00S21 October 2000

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that certain 2000 model year cars and light trucks fail to conform to the requirements specified in the Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standard (FMVSS) Standard No. 209: Seat Belt Assemblies, paragraph S4.4 (b)(3), which requires the structural components in a seat belt assembly that are common to pelvic and upper torso restraints to withstand a force of not less than 13,345 N (3,000 lbs).

What the non-compliance issue is…

In the affected vehicles, some seat belt buckles have been installed that may not withstand the force required by FMVSS.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

Your dealer will inspect the date code on certain seat belt buckles of your vehicle and replace all seat belt buckles that fall within the suspect date code range.

Your dealer will perform this service free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer to have the seat belt buckles inspected.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 00S21.

If inspection reveals that a seat belt buckle assembly needs to be replaced, your dealer will need to order the part. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

If a part needs to be ordered, Ford Motor Company has authorized your dealer to provide you with a rental vehicle until the parts arrive and are installed on your vehicle.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs